

SENIOR LIVING

India's ageing population is creating a huge market for homes that allow seniors to move from a care-led to a lifestyle-led proposition. However, building a viable model will require scale, capital and a new care ecosystem

110 |

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THE PHRASE 'SENIOR housing' has come a long way from old-age homes: dilapidated buildings, minimal services, poor facilities and basic healthcare to spell premium lifestyle communities.

As India's elderly population grows and more affluent seniors enter the market, senior housing is evolving into 'senior living'—communities that combine independence, social life, wellness, healthcare and assisted living, albeit at a price.

People from a variety of professional backgrounds are moving into senior homes, with industry estimates pointing to 80-85% occupancy at

well-established communities.

"We have people who come from professional backgrounds, government and PSUs, the armed forces, as well as doctors and professors. There are also several residents from business backgrounds," says Ankur Gupta, Joint Managing Director of Ashiana Housing. "Having lived a rich and fulfilling career, they opt for communities that give them the freedom of choosing activities they never got time to pursue in their working years."

"People don't necessarily want somebody to 'look after' them; they want people to have dinner with, travel with, exercise with and pursue interests with," says Adarsh Narahari, Founder & Managing

Director of Primus Senior Living and Marzi By Primus.

And it's not only the seniors themselves who are looking for appropriate housing for the next stage of their lives. "We see significant interest from people in their 40s and 50s exploring senior living for their parents," says Dhruv Badruka, Co-Founder of Amaya Senior Living, a fledgling senior living developer and operator in Hyderabad. "Over time, we expect senior living to increasingly become a planned lifestyle decision rather than a need-based decision."

These trends are creating a big market for developers and senior living operators. According to the India Ageing Report 2023, people aged 60 years and more comprised